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County saw need for flood alarm months ago

Texas rebuffed local officials seeking funds

By Christopher Flavelle,
J. David Goodman, and Andrea Fuller
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — The warning last fall was, in retrospect, achingly prescient.

“It is likely” Kerr County “will experience a flood event in the next year,” local officials concluded in a report for the Federal Emergency Management Agency released in October. Such floods, they added, could pose a particular danger to people in “substandard structures” and result in “increased damage, injuries, or loss of life.”

►President Trump toured the catastrophic flood damage in Texas. **A2.**

One solution, county officials said, would be a flood warning system to alert residents to rising waters. They estimated the cost at less than \$1 million and noted FEMA could pay for it.

But by the time floodwaters raged down the Guadalupe River the morning of July 4, killing at least 121, including at least 36 children, no such alarm system had been installed in Kerr County.

WARNING, Page A7

DAVID GERGEN 1942-2025

Washington veteran who advised four presidents

By Clyde Haberman
NEW YORK TIMES

David Gergen, an inside-the-Beltway veteran who helped shape the public images of four presidents, mostly Republicans, and who, after a turn as a magazine editor, trod a well-worn path from political insider to television commentator, died Thursday in Lexington. He was 83.

His death, at a retirement community, was caused by Lewy body dementia, said his son, Christopher. Mr. Gergen previously lived in Cambridge.

It was Mr. Gergen who devised a line in the 1980 presidential election that helped secure victory for the Republican candidate, Ronald Reagan, over Jimmy Carter, the incumbent Democrat. In that era of high inflation, onerous interest rates, and a national psyche wounded by Iran's holding of 52 Americans hostage, Carter was on the ropes. The clincher came in a televised debate a week before the election when Reagan asked viewers a Gergen-suggested question that hit political pay dirt: “Are you better off than you were four years ago?”

For many Americans, the answer was no.

“Rhetorical questions have great power,” Mr. Gergen said years later.

“It's one of those things that you sometimes strike gold,” he said. “When you're out there panhandling in the river, occasionally you get a gold nugget.”

Mr. Gergen mined as many of those

GERGEN, Page C9

TOASTS OF THE OLD TOWN

In Boston pubs' claims to history, it can be the spirit that matters



PHOTOS BY JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

The Green Dragon (top left) and the Bell in Hand (top right) proclaim their historic bona fides, but the truth is a little trickier. And the Union Oyster House (above) is in a building dating to 1716, but it has undergone many changes over the decades.

By Danny McDonald

GLOBE STAFF

It's an eye-catching proclamation, made along a route of historic tourism that draws millions each year: The Bell in Hand contends it is “America's oldest continuously operating tavern.”

You have to read the proverbial fine print on the bar's exterior to see it hasn't always been in this location, that it's moved multiple times.

Across the street is the Green Dragon Tavern, the name of an important meeting place for revolutionaries in the 18th century. The current bar inundates passersby with various dates — 1657, 1773, 1776 — on a wooden sign that proclaims it to be the “headquarters of the revolution.”

But a plaque by its doorway cops to the real story: The original Green Dragon was located “near this spot.” The current iteration opened in 1993.

What's authentic and what is a marketing ploy? In the heart of the Hub, that line can be as blurry as a frosted beer mug.

Take the warren of streets just across North Street from Faneuil Hall, where the Green Dragon and Bell in Hand are located. It's probably what most tourists think of when they think of revolutionary Boston, despite many of the buildings having been constructed decades after that war. There are cobblestone streets,

HISTORIC BARS, Page A10

‘If there were easier options to take, we definitely would prefer those.’

YI-AN HUANG, *Cambridge city manager*

Cambridge takes over doomed building

Mt. Auburn Street to partially close during demolition

By Spencer Buell

GLOBE STAFF

CAMBRIDGE — Gripped by increasing concern over the dangers posed by a structurally faulty condo building on the Charles River, the City of Cambridge plans to take control of its demolition and will shut down

part of a major roadway beginning next weekend.

The process of tearing down the 66-unit Riverview building at 221 Mt. Auburn St., which residents evacuated last year amid problems with its concrete, will be extremely complex — one of Cambridge's largest and most disruptive projects in years, officials said. They are aiming for the demolition to be completed before winter.

In an effort to keep pedestrians and passing cars out of harm's way in case the building suddenly collapses,

part of Mt. Auburn Street will be closed to all traffic beginning on Saturday, July 19, for at least several months.

City Manager Yi-An Huang acknowledged this next stretch would be a difficult one for neighbors.

“If there were easier options to take, we definitely would prefer those,” he said, speaking at a public meeting Thursday night.

The extraordinary city involvement comes after Cambridge's inspection

BUILDING, Page A10

Nantucket in \$10.5m turbine settlement

By Sabrina Shankman

and Travis Andersen

GLOBE STAFF

Almost one year after a wind turbine blade came apart, sending fiberglass and other debris into the ocean and onto Nantucket beaches, Nantucket officials announced a multimillion dollar settlement with GE Vernova on Friday.

The \$10.5 million settlement will compensate the town and local businesses for losses resulting from the July 13, 2024, blade failure at Vineyard Wind's offshore energy project, which is now set for completion at year's end. Town officials recalled Friday how teenage and young adult lifeguards had rushed into the surf to clear debris in the immediate aftermath of the accident.

“They had no idea it was going to be a constant wave of debris,” said Nantucket select board member Brooke Mohr.

Eventually, at the height of the summer season, the town had to close beaches —

NANTUCKET, Page A7

Sticky, wicked

Saturday: Humid, some sun.
High: 75-89. Low: 63-68

Sunday: Still humid.
High: 78-83. Low: 66-71.

Sunrise: 5:18 Sunset: 8:21

Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**

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DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

CLEANUP CREW

A Massachusetts State Trooper along with MassDOT workers moved firefighting foam off the Massachusetts Turnpike after an electric vehicle caught fire just beyond the Prudential Tunnel. The fire happened shortly after 7 Friday morning, temporarily closing the westbound lanes. No injuries were reported.

The state's health secretary, Kate Walsh, is stepping down and will be replaced by Dr. Kiame Mahaniah starting Monday. **B1.**

The Red Sox won their eighth straight, stunning the Rays with a walkoff homer by Ceddanne Rafaela. **C1.**